

ATPL EASA STUDY GUIDE | 010 - AIR LAW

Chapter 4: Flight Crew Licensing & Medical

Syllabus Source: CAE Oxford (pp. 67-100) | Pass Target: >= 90% AviationExam

1. EUROPEAN REGULATORY FRAMEWORK (PART-FCL)

Flight Crew Licensing in Europe is governed by Commission Regulation (EU) No 1178/2011 (Part-FCL). A licence grants basic piloting privileges, but is valid ONLY when accompanied by a valid Class or Type Rating, a valid Medical Certificate, and proof of language proficiency (ICAO English Level 4 minimum).

2. LICENCES: AGE LIMITS, EXPERIENCE & PRIVILEGES

Licence	Min Age	Minimum Experience Requirements	Privileges & Limitations
LAPL(A)	17 years	30 hours flight time (15 dual, 6 solo).	Light Aircraft Pilot Licence. Max 2,000 kg MTOM, max 4 persons, non-commercial only. Valid only in EASA Member States (non-ICAO).
PPL(A)	17 years	45 hours flight time (25 dual, 10 solo including 5 solo cross-country with 1 qualifying flight >= 150 NM with 2 landings).	Private Pilot Licence. Fly without remuneration as PIC or co-pilot in non-commercial ops. ICAO Annex 1 compliant. (Exception: can receive payment if working as authorized FI or FE).
CPL(A)	18 years	Modular: 200 hours (or Integrated: 150 hours). Breakdown: 100 hrs PIC, 20 hrs cross-country PIC with 300 NM flight, 10 hrs instrument, 5 hrs night.	Commercial Pilot Licence. Exercise all PPL privileges; act as PIC in commercial air transport on single-pilot aeroplanes; act as co-pilot in multi-pilot aeroplanes.
MPL(A)	18 years	Minimum 240 hours of flight and simulator training in an approved course.	Multi-crew Pilot Licence. Exercise co-pilot privileges in commercial air transport restricted to multi-pilot aeroplanes.
ATPL(A)	21 years	1,500 hours total flight time (see detailed breakdown below).	Airline Transport Pilot Licence. Act as PIC or co-pilot in commercial air transport on multi-pilot aeroplanes.

ATPL(A) 1,500-Hour Mandatory Breakdown (AviationExam Core)

To qualify for the issue of an ATPL(A), the applicant must complete at least 1,500 hours of flight time including:

- 500 hours in multi-pilot operations on aeroplanes.
- 250 hours as PIC, OR at least 500 hours as PICUS (PIC Under Supervision), OR 70 hours PIC and the remainder as PICUS.
- 200 hours of cross-country flight time, of which at least 100 hours must be as PIC or PICUS.
- 75 hours of instrument flight time, of which a maximum of 30 hours may be instrument ground time (FSTD).
- 100 hours of night flight as PIC or co-pilot.

[!] EXAM TRAP (AVIATIONEXAM) - Commercial Remuneration for PPL Holders

Can a PPL holder receive remuneration for flying? Answer: NO, as a general rule.

EXCEPTION: A PPL holder who holds an authorized Flight Instructor (FI) or Flight Examiner (FE) certificate may receive remuneration for providing flight instruction or testing.

3. RATINGS: CLASS, TYPE, INSTRUMENT (IR) & REVALIDATION

- Class Rating: Authorizes pilot on non-complex, single-pilot aeroplanes: SEP (Single Engine Piston - valid 2 years), MEP (Multi Engine Piston - valid 1 year), TMG (Touring Motor Glider).
- Type Rating: Required for: 1) Each multi-pilot aeroplane (e.g. A320, B737), 2) Single-pilot high-performance complex aeroplanes. Valid 1 year.
- Instrument Rating (IR): Authorizes flight under IFR with Category I minimums (DH $\geq$ 200 ft). Valid 1 year.

Revalidation vs Renewal (Crucial Regulatory Distinction)

- Revalidation: The administrative action taken within the period of validity of a rating which allows the holder to continue to exercise the privileges (performed BEFORE expiry).
- Renewal: The administrative action taken AFTER a rating has expired for the purpose of renewing the privileges. Requires refresher training at an ATO + proficiency check with examiner.

[!] EXAM TRAP (AVIATIONEXAM) - SEP Class Rating Revalidation Rules (Very Frequently Tested)

For revalidation of a Single-Engine Piston (SEP) class rating by experience, the pilot must within the 12 MONTHS preceding the expiry date of the rating: 1. Complete at least 12 HOURS of flight time, including: - 6 hours as PIC; - 12 take-offs and 12 landings; AND - A training flight of at least 1 HOUR with a Flight Instructor (FI). OR: Pass a proficiency check with an examiner within the 3 months preceding expiry.

4. RECENT EXPERIENCE REQUIREMENTS (PART-FCL.060)

A pilot shall NOT act as PIC or co-pilot carrying passengers unless:

- Day Flight: Has carried out at least 3 take-offs and 3 landings in the preceding 90 DAYS on the same class/type or approved FSTD.
- Night Flight: Has carried out at least 1 take-off and 1 landing at NIGHT in the preceding 90 DAYS as flying pilot, UNLESS holding an active Instrument Rating (IR).

5. PART-MED: MEDICAL CERTIFICATION & VALIDITY

Medical Class	Applies To	Standard Validity & Age Reductions
Class 1	CPL, ATPL, MPL (Commercial Air Transport)	12 months (Under 60 years). Reduced to 6 months if: aged 60+, OR aged 40+ in single-pilot commercial passenger operations.
Class 2	PPL, Sailplane, Balloon (Private flying)	60 months (Under 40 years). 24 months (40 to 49 years). 12 months (50 years and over).
LAPL	LAPL(A), LAPL(H)	60 months (Under 40 years). 24 months (40 years and over).

Decrease in Medical Fitness: Mandatory Reporting

A pilot MUST notify the Aero-Medical Examiner (AME) and suspend flight privileges in cases of: - Hospital admission or clinic stay exceeding 12 hours. - Any significant surgical operation or invasive procedure. - Illness causing incapacity to fly for 21 DAYS or more (Class 1) or 30 DAYS or more (Class 2/LAPL). - Pregnancy: Pilot may fly until end of the 26th week of gestation under multi-pilot ops with Class 1 medical.

6. AGE LIMITATIONS FOR COMMERCIAL OPERATIONS (PART-FCL.065)

[!] EXAM TRAP (AVIATIONEXAM) - The Rule of 60 and 65 (Part-FCL.065)

- Age 60 to 64: A pilot licence holder who has reached age 60 shall NOT act as pilot in commercial air transport EXCEPT as member of a multi-pilot crew, and provided the other pilot is UNDER 60 YEARS OF AGE. - Age 65: Absolute cutoff. No pilot aged 65 or over may act as pilot in commercial air transport.

7. ATPL THEORY VALIDITY & CREDITING RULES

- ATPL Theoretical Knowledge Examination Pass: Remains valid for the issue of a CPL(A) or IR(A) for a period of 36 MONTHS from the day the pilot successfully passes all theoretical exams. - IR Validity to ATPL: Provided an IR(A) or type rating is kept valid (or renewed within 7 years of last expiry), the ATPL theoretical examination credits remain valid indefinitely for the issue of an ATPL(A). - Multi-Crew Cooperation (MCC): Mandatory before flying multi-pilot aircraft. 25 hours theoretical instruction and at least 20 hours simulator (or 16 hours in FNPT II).

8. PART-MED CLINICAL EXAMINATION STANDARDS

Clinical Parameter	Regulatory Medical Standards (EASA Part-MED Class 1)
Visual Acuity	Distant visual acuity 6/9 (0.7) in each eye, 6/6 (1.0) with both eyes. Refractive error limits: +5.0 to -6.0 diopters. Astigmatism max 2.0 diopters. Spare pair of glasses mandatory.
Color Vision	Normal trichromatic color vision required. Tested with Ishihara 24 plates (must pass 15 plates on first try). If failed, advanced testing (CAD test / Anomaloscope) required.
Hearing (Audiometry)	Pure tone audiometry: Max hearing loss of 20 dB at 500, 1000, 2000 Hz; max 35 dB at 3000 Hz in each ear separately.
Cardiovascular (ECG)	Standard resting 12-lead ECG required at initial exam, every 5 years up to age 30, every 2 years up to age 40, annually up to age 50, and at all subsequent medicals.
Alcohol & Drugs	Blood Alcohol Concentration (BAC) limit: 0.20 g/l (0.02%). Bottle-to-throttle rule: Minimum 8 hours between alcohol consumption and flight duty.

9. AVIATIONEXAM PRACTICE QUESTIONS (WITH EXPLANATIONS)

Q1: What is the total flight time required for the issue of an ATPL(A)?

- [A]: 500 hours
- [B]: 1,000 hours
- [C]: 1,500 hours
- [D]: 2,000 hours

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [C]. 1,500 hours total flight time is mandatory for ATPL(A), including 500 hours multi-pilot and 250 hours PIC (or 500 PICUS).

Q2: What is the validity of a Class 1 medical certificate for a 45-year-old pilot flying single-pilot commercial pas

- [A]: 6 months

- [B]: 12 months
- [C]: 24 months
- [D]: 60 months

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [A]. Under Part-MED, Class 1 validity is reduced from 12 months to 6 months for pilots aged 40 and over operating single-pilot commercial passenger operations (or age 60+ in any commercial air transport).

Q3: What are the recent experience requirements to carry passengers by day under Part-FCL.060?

- [A]: 3 take-offs and landings in the preceding 60 days
- [B]: 3 take-offs and landings in the preceding 90 days
- [C]: 5 take-offs and landings in the preceding 90 days
- [D]: 10 hours in the preceding 30 days

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [B]. The pilot must have completed at least 3 take-offs and landings as flying pilot on the same type/class or FSTD in the preceding 90 days.

Q4: Under what conditions may a pilot aged 62 act as pilot in commercial air transport?

- [A]: In single-pilot operations only
- [B]: As a member of a multi-pilot crew, provided the other pilot is under 60
- [C]: Never, commercial operations stop at 60
- [D]: Only during domestic daytime flights

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [B]. Between ages 60 and 64, commercial air transport is permitted only in a multi-pilot crew where the other pilot is under age 60.

Q5: What is the revalidation requirement by experience for a Single-Engine Piston (SEP) class rating?

- [A]: 10 hours flight time in the preceding 6 months
- [B]: 12 hours flight time including 6 hours PIC, 12 take-offs/landings, and 1 hour with an FI within the preceding 12 months
- [C]: Passing a theoretical examination every 2 years
- [D]: 3 take-offs and landings within the preceding 90 days

[?] OFFICIAL RATIONALE & ANALYSIS - Detailed Answer Explanation

CORRECT: [B]. SEP revalidation by experience requires 12 hours (6 PIC, 12 take-offs/landings, 1 hour training flight with FI) within the 12 months preceding expiry.